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What.Exchange Project Viability Report (December 2025)

Project Overview

Mission & Vision: What.Exchange is a decentralized **perpetual futures exchange** built to embody crypto's original ethos of transparency, community ownership, and self-custody. The project's mission is to return power and revenue to users, countering the "toxic" practices of many centralized exchanges (CEXs) [1] [2]. The founder – a veteran Bitcoiner who entered crypto in 2012 – was motivated by disillusionment with how CEXs and VCs "farm" users for profit [3] [1]. In response, What.Exchange aims to create a **community-driven trading platform** where >90% of exchange revenue is paid back to users (via continuous token buybacks) and governance is handed over to a DAO [4] [5]. The guiding vision is a *CeDeFi* hybrid: offer a **"CEX-like" trading experience with DeFi principles** (non-custodial wallets and on-chain transparency) [6] [7].

Background & Launch: What.Exchange was founded in 2024 by a pseudonymous trader known as "Wolf" [8]. Wolf (formerly known as *WolfOfPoloniex* in the crypto trading community) is a well-known crypto veteran and influencer. He has been a professional trader since around 2016 and had even launched a personal community token ($WOLF) back in 2017 [9]. Wolf's credibility comes from years of market experience and a following on crypto Twitter (tens of thousands of followers). Notably, his profile indicates he was a seed investor in projects like **Orderly Network and WOO Network** [10], aligning with What.Exchange's integration of those technologies (more below). The What.Exchange platform went live in mid-2025, initially in a "point farming" phase where early users could trade to earn points toward a future token airdrop [11]. By June 2025, the exchange was operational and seeing rapid growth in usage (e.g. ~$10M to $25M in weekly trading volume within the first three weeks) [12] [13]. The project is **self-funded with no VC backers**, which the team touts as allowing them to stay true to community-first principles [14].

Product and Services

Platform Description: What.Exchange is a **decentralized perpetual futures trading platform** that lets users trade crypto with up to **50× leverage directly from their own wallets** [15]. In practice, it functions similarly to a centralized futures exchange but without a custodian – users connect their Web3 wallet (no account signup or KYC required) and trade on-chain. Under the hood, What.Exchange is built on an **orderbook-based** DEX infrastructure (powered by Orderly Network) and uses **LayerZero omnichain** technology to operate across multiple blockchains [4] [16]. This means traders on various chains (Ethereum, Solana, BNB Chain, Layer-2s, etc.) can access a unified orderbook and liquidity pool. The goal is to **"defragment" liquidity** across the highly fragmented crypto ecosystem by making all products available on every major chain via cross-chain messaging [17]. In essence, What.Exchange is providing a single platform for perpetual trading that **aggregates liquidity and users from many networks** into one experience.

Core Features: Traders on What.Exchange can long or short a wide range of crypto assets (see **Supported Assets** below) with typical futures exchange features: an order book, limit/market orders, charting, etc. The UI offers a professional trading interface, including **TradingView charts and <100ms**

trade execution – performance that rivals centralized exchanges [18] [19]. Trading fees are kept very low (*Maker: 0.02%, Taker: 0.05%*), on par with top CEX fee tiers [20]. The platform also supports **API trading**, enabling algorithmic traders and brokers to plug in via API for high-frequency trading or to build their own front-ends [18]. There is an emphasis on **security and self-custody** – all trades are executed on a decentralized infrastructure (with **no custody of user funds** at the exchange level) [21]. Features like multi-collateral support (using various tokens as margin) are documented in the platform docs [22]. An **insurance fund** mechanism is in place to handle liquidation shortfalls and protect traders from counterparty risk, similar to the approach used by major futures exchanges [23] [24].

Supported Assets and Markets: One standout aspect is the **breadth of markets** available. All perpetual contracts on What.Exchange are denominated in USDC, and as of Q4 2025 the platform lists dozens of crypto assets for perpetual trading [25]. These include all major cryptocurrencies – e.g. Bitcoin (BTC), Ethereum (ETH), Solana (SOL), Arbitrum (ARB), Dogecoin (DOGE), Chainlink (LINK), Tron (TRX), Litecoin (LTC) and more – as well as many trending altcoins and meme coins [26] [27]. For example, one can trade perps on new projects like Celestia (TIA) or Worldcoin (WLD), DeFi tokens like Aave (AAVE) and Maker (MKR), *and* even meme-themed contracts like "OFFICIAL TRUMP" or "Melania Meme" tokens [27] [28]. This broad market offering shows that What.Exchange is targeting both serious traders (with large-cap assets and DeFi tokens) and the degen community (with highly speculative meme coins). The inclusion of very new Layer-1 tokens (e.g. Sui, Sei, Berachain's BERA, "Mode", "Plume", etc.) indicates the platform quickly onboards emerging projects to attract their communities [29] [30].

Services & Future Products: While perpetual futures trading is the primary service, the project envisions a **full "trading suite."** In 2024–25 they focused on launching the perps exchange, but they have hinted at additional products in development. For instance, an **Educational Platform** is being built to complement the exchange – by mid-2025 the team was "finalizing development" of this educational platform [31]. This likely will offer trading education or research content (aligning with the project's blog producing weekly on-chain analysis). Additionally, the team plans to roll out a **crypto debit card** linked to What.Exchange, to facilitate easy on/off ramps for traders. In a recent update, they announced *"we will be launching crypto debit cards to provide on/off-ramp solutions for What Exchange traders, with no extra fees on top of merchant fees"* [32]. This suggests a move toward bridging DeFi with everyday usability (a CeFi-like convenience for DeFi users). The platform's **staking** or **rewards** features are likely to come once the $WHAT token launches – e.g. staking $WHAT for revenue share or using it in governance (details in **Tokenomics** section). Overall, What.Exchange's product offering is positioned to deliver a **one-stop trading experience**: multi-chain perpetuals trading, educational resources, fiat gateways (debit card), and eventually community governance and staking.

Team and Leadership

Core Team: The project's driving force is its founder and CEO, known pseudonymously as **"Wolf"** (Twitter: @ImNotTheWolf). Wolf has a notable reputation in the crypto community, having been active for over a decade. In his founder's message, he recounts joining crypto in 2012 and witnessing the evolution from the early "#HODL" days to the current landscape [3]. Prior to building What.Exchange, Wolf was known as *"WolfOfPoloniex"* – a prominent trader persona on crypto Twitter around 2016–2017. He launched a personal token ($WOLF) in 2017 as a community experiment and became a well-followed crypto commentator [9]. This background as a **professional crypto trader turned builder** is explicitly noted in his bio and lends credibility to his understanding of traders' needs [33]. Wolf is also well-connected: he was an early seed investor in several relevant projects, including **WOO Network**, **Orderly Network**, and **Mantle (MNT)** [34]. These affiliations suggest that the founder has industry support and insight (for example, WOO/Orderly provide the tech backbone for What.Exchange, and Mantle is one of the L2 networks the exchange supports).

Beyond the founder, **other team members** have not been very publicly detailed (likely by design, given the focus on community and decentralization). The project often uses a lighthearted "intern" persona on social media (the @whatintern account) to engage the community, implying a small dedicated team that wears many hats. The **engineering** likely involves smart contract developers and integration specialists, especially given the complexity of bridging multiple chains and integrating Orderly's APIs. Although names aren't published on the website, the professionalism of the platform and documentation suggests an experienced development team, possibly with backgrounds in trading tech. It's worth noting that **no traditional VC investors or board members** are involved – Wolf emphasized *"We are self-funded. We owe nothing to anyone."* [14] . This means the leadership is free from investor pressure, but also that the team's credibility hinges on Wolf's persona and the product's performance, rather than known corporate backers.

Credibility and Affiliations: Wolf's long tenure in crypto and existing following provide a level of trust within the community. He explicitly founded What.Exchange to counter the lack of transparency he observed elsewhere [1] , and he aligns the project with respected DeFi models (citing admiration for **HyperLiquid** and **Curve DAO** as role models for honesty and governance [35] [5]). Being a seed investor in Orderly and WOO, the founder likely has a close working relationship with those teams; indeed, Orderly Network is a core partner for What.Exchange (Wolf's stake in Orderly's $ORDER token suggests confidence in that tech) [34] . This kind of alignment can be seen as a positive – the team isn't building in isolation but rather is plugged into a larger DeFi ecosystem. However, outside of Wolf, the **team's identities are mostly under wraps**. Prospective partners might note that a pseudonymous team is common in DeFi, but it does place more importance on track record. So far, there have been no controversies around the team; no rug-pulls or security scandals are associated with them. Wolf's personal token $WOLF is a niche project but has an active community and has not been reported as a scam (its model involves Wolf using trading profits to buy back the token) [9] . This unconventional approach exemplifies the **"degenerate but honest" ethos** the team embraces – even their slogan is *"Built by Traders, Owned by Degens"* [36] . In summary, the leadership appears credible within crypto-native circles, combining trading expertise with a community-first philosophy, albeit without the formal oversight of outside investors.

Tokenomics

$WHAT Token Overview: *$WHAT* is the native token of the What.Exchange ecosystem. It has not yet been officially launched/tradable as of Dec 2025 – instead, users have been **farming airdrop points** which will convert into $WHAT once the token generation event occurs [11] . The team explicitly calls $WHAT the *"core of the whole What.Exchange ecosystem"*, rather than just an exchange fee token [37] . In other words, $WHAT is meant to accrue value from all aspects of the project (perpetual trading, future education platform, etc.) and confer governance rights, not unlike how $GMX or $DYDX function in their respective DEX ecosystems. Key expected utilities of $WHAT include: **governance/voting power in a future DAO**, entitlement to a share of platform revenue (via buybacks or staking mechanisms), and possibly access to special features or tiers on the platform [5] [4] . The token design is **deflationary** – the exchange uses 90%+ of its revenue to continuously buy back $WHAT from the market, which should reduce supply or redistribute tokens to active participants [4] . This model mirrors HyperLiquid's approach (HyperLiquid's HYPE token also had a large initial airdrop and then a buyback-driven design) [38] [39] .

Supply and Allocation: The total supply of $WHAT has not been publicly announced yet. However, the **allocation plan is partially known**: **30% of the total supply is reserved for a community airdrop** [38] . This sizable airdrop (exactly the same percentage HyperLiquid used for HYPE's launch) is meant to reward early adopters/traders on What.Exchange. Users earn points now by trading (and possibly by other contributions) which will translate into $WHAT tokens when the airdrop occurs [40] . The remaining

70% of the supply is expected to cover the team, treasury, liquidity incentives, and future community rewards, but detailed breakdowns have not been published as of yet. Importantly, **no tokens have been sold in any ICO/IEO** – the project was *"fair launched"* with no venture or private sale allocations [14]. This implies the **Team allocation** (if any) likely comes from that remaining 70%, and one can expect a multi-year vesting if they emulate typical fair-launch projects (to ensure the team is long-term aligned). Additionally, a portion will likely go to a **DAO Treasury** to fund ongoing development and community initiatives (e.g. trading competitions, liquidity mining if introduced, etc.).

To summarize the known tokenomics, here's a tentative allocation table:

Token Allocation	Percentage	Details
Community Airdrop (Retrodrop to early users)	**30%**	To reward and decentralize ownership among initial traders and supporters [38]. Users accrue points now which will convert to $WHAT in this allocation.
Team & Contributors	*TBD* (undisclosed)	The project is self-funded with no VC, so any team allocation comes from remaining supply. Expected to be modest and likely vested, given the "fair launch" ethos [14]. Exact percentage not yet announced.
Treasury & Ecosystem (Future Incentives)	*TBD*	A portion of supply will be set aside for the DAO treasury, liquidity provision, marketing, and partnerships. This ensures funds for long-term growth (e.g. liquidity mining, exchange insurance fund, etc.). Not yet quantified publicly.
Total Supply	**100%**	*Total number of $WHAT tokens TBD.* The only fixed number known is the 30% for airdrop; remaining distribution will be detailed closer to token launch (expected in 2026).

Vesting & Emission: Since the token is not live, exact vesting schedules aren't available. However, one can infer that the **airdrop 30% will likely be claimable by users at or soon after TGE** (similar to HyperLiquid's approach where the genesis airdrop was fully distributed [41]). The team/treasury allocations will presumably vest over time to ensure gradual release (preventing a supply shock and demonstrating commitment). The token model is highly **deflationary** post-launch: the exchange's revenue (trading fees) is used for **continuous buybacks of $WHAT on the open market** [4]. Those bought tokens might be burned or redistributed as staking rewards; either way, this means net effective supply will decrease as the platform grows, assuming trading volume and fees are generated. There may also be **fee-discount or staking utilities** for $WHAT (e.g. staking $WHAT might entitle one to a share of fees or higher referral commissions), but such features will likely be announced with the token launch details. The founder has clarified that *"$WHAT isn't an exchange token [in the narrow sense]; it's the core of the whole ecosystem"*, suggesting it underpins not just trading fees but also an upcoming education platform and other community-driven programs [37].

Token Performance: As of now, $WHAT does not have price or market cap data since it's not trading yet. No exchange listings have occurred (apart from speculation, one can find no $WHAT on CoinGecko or major DEXs). This is a double-edged sword: on one hand, there's **no existing liquidity or performance history** to evaluate; on the other, it means early partners/affiliates could be in a position to benefit when the token launches (assuming a successful launch and price appreciation following the airdrop). It's worth noting the context: HyperLiquid's HYPE token airdrop in Nov 2024 was extremely lucrative, reaching a multi-billion fully diluted value [42]. While there's no guarantee $WHAT will replicate that, the team explicitly references HyperLiquid's 30% airdrop as inspiration [38], indicating they hope to create similar community buzz and value. Once launched, $WHAT will likely be listed on DEXs first (possibly on multiple chains, given the omnichain nature, maybe via LayerZero-enabled pools) and potentially on partner CEXs. For now, anyone "investing" in $WHAT is really investing time and trading volume to farm the airdrop, rather than buying tokens. From a partnership perspective, the tokenomics seem *highly user-centric* (large free distribution, no VC overhang, ongoing buybacks), which is attractive as it aligns incentives with the community. The main risk is that details on supply cap and distribution of the remaining 70% are not public, so one will have to trust the team until the official tokenomics paper is released.

Affiliate and Partner Program

What.Exchange runs an affiliate (referral) program aimed at onboarding **partners/influencers** who can bring traders to the platform in exchange for generous commissions. The program is pitched as an exclusive, high-quality affiliate club rather than an open-to-all referral scheme [43]. Here are the key points:

- **Commission Structure:** Affiliates earn **40% of the trading fees** generated by their referred users [44]. This is a very competitive rate – for comparison, top exchanges like Binance and OKX usually offer 20–50% of fees, so 40% puts What.Exchange on the high end of payouts. There is no mention of a tier system; it appears to be a flat 40% share for approved affiliates. (There's also a hint of sub-affiliate benefits – e.g. the docs mention "unlock exclusive perks", but no explicit multi-level commission is described.)

- **Payout Methods:** The documentation does not explicitly state how commissions are paid, but given the platform's nature, one can assume payouts are made in crypto (likely USDC or USDT) to the affiliate's account on the exchange. Commissions probably accrue in real-time as users trade (most exchanges tally this on a dashboard). The affiliates may withdraw their earnings periodically. Since What.Exchange is non-custodial for trading, it's possible the referral system operates off-chain via an affiliate portal (perhaps in the *"Rewards"* section mentioned). **Frequency** of payouts isn't stated, but typically it could be weekly or monthly. We did not find a specific mention of minimum withdrawal thresholds or similar constraints.

- **Exclusive Benefits:** Beyond the commission rate, What.Exchange promises various perks to affiliates, emphasizing a **"white-glove" treatment**. According to the program blurb, affiliates receive **1:1 service with 24/7 support**, meaning a dedicated account manager or support channel [45]. They also offer **marketing support** – e.g. help with running trading competitions or promotional campaigns for the affiliate's audience [46]. Affiliates can get **social media and content support**, possibly co-marketing or shoutouts from What.Exchange's official channels. There's mention of **VIP events and merchandise** for affiliates [46], underscoring that the program is aiming to build a close-knit community of partners. Essentially, affiliates are treated as an extension of the team's marketing force, with resources to help them succeed.

- **How to Join & Requirements:** The affiliate program is **application-based**. Interested partners must fill out a form in the platform's Rewards section [47] (or via a provided link). The team then reviews applicants. The wording suggests they are **selective**, looking for "reputable and trusted" individuals or communities [43]. Likely ideal candidates are crypto influencers, trading community leaders, YouTubers, educators, etc., who have an audience interested in crypto trading. Because the program is *"small but high-quality"* by design [48], having a significant following or niche community is probably necessary. There's no explicit follower count requirement given, but one can infer that a proven track record (perhaps references or an interview) might be part of the vetting. In short, **quality over quantity** in affiliate selection. Once approved, an affiliate gets a unique referral link or code to distribute. Notably, by mid-2025 the team was working on **automated referral link activation** [31], which implies the referral tracking system is robust.

- **Commission Payout Details:** While not directly stated, it's typical that referred users get some benefit too (for example, many exchanges give referred users a fee discount). The docs did not mention a referee bonus, so it might be that all 40% comes out of the platform's fee share and the new user pays the same fees regardless. Payouts are likely in real-time to an affiliate dashboard. Given the platform's multi-chain nature, the commissions might accumulate on whichever chain the trading occurred (if on-chain) or off-chain if Orderly handles it centrally. We expect that affiliates can withdraw their earnings in USDC on a supported chain.

Below is a summary of the affiliate program in table form:

Affiliate Program Feature	Description
Commission Rate	**40% of trading fees** from referred users [44]. This is a high payout, intended to attract top promoters.
Payout Method & Frequency	Commissions accrue in the affiliate's account (likely in USDC or similar). *Exact payout schedule not stated*, but typically available for withdrawal periodically. No KYC is mentioned, so payouts are in crypto.
Affiliate Perks	- Dedicated 1:1 support (around the clock) [45]. - Support for running trading competitions or marketing campaigns to engage referrals [46]. - Social media shoutouts or content collaboration with What.Exchange's team [46]. - Access to exclusive events, possible merchandise, and a sense of being part of an elite affiliate team [46].
Requirements	- Must apply and be approved (via form on site) [47]. - Should have a reputable profile in the crypto space – e.g. an influencer, community leader, or content creator with a solid following [43]. - Focus is on quality: the program is limited in number of affiliates, so demonstrating trustworthiness and an alignment with What.Exchange's values (transparency, etc.) is important.
Referral Link Mechanics	After approval, affiliates receive a unique referral link or code. New users coming via the link are tagged to the affiliate. The program was being automated for ease of use [31]. No mention of expiration; likely permanent attribution.

Overall Impressions: The affiliate program's generosity (40% commission) and personalized support indicate that What.Exchange is aggressively trying to onboard partners who can **evangelize the platform early on**. Since the exchange is relatively new, affiliates stand to benefit from being early – less competition in referrals and the potential upside if $WHAT token rewards or bonuses are later given to affiliates. For example, some projects reward top referrers with extra token incentives; while not stated, it wouldn't be surprising if What.Exchange does something similar around token launch. From a viability standpoint, the existence of this program shows that What.Exchange is serious about growth through community networks. For someone considering a partnership or affiliate relationship, the terms are attractive. We'd just caution that as a young platform, an affiliate's earning potential depends on What.Exchange continuing to grow its trader base and volume (the commission on zero volume is zero, after all). But given the support they provide, a committed affiliate could help drive that growth. The **lack of any apparent negatives (e.g. no reports of delayed payouts or changes in terms)** is expected since the program is new. It will be important to maintain open communication with the team (which seems readily available on Discord/Twitter) – the 1:1 support promise is encouraging on that front.

Roadmap and Development

What.Exchange's roadmap has been characterized by rapid development in 2024–2025, with a focus on launching the core exchange and then layering in additional features. The official website cheekily lists the roadmap as "To infinity and beyond" [49], implying an ambitious long-term vision without strict public timelines. However, through team communications and updates, we can outline past milestones and future plans:

Development Milestones (Past):

- **2024 Q4 – Project Inception:** Project founded by Wolf in 2024 [8]. Early development likely involved integrating Orderly Network's backend and building the front-end interface. By late 2024 or early 2025, a closed testing or internal beta might have been conducted (though not widely publicized).

- **2025 Q2 – Alpha Launch (Point Farming Begins):** The exchange went live in a limited capacity around May 2025. Early users were invited to trade and farm "WHAT Points" in anticipation of the future airdrop [11]. During this phase, the team engaged crypto communities to try the platform. They reported initial stats in weekly "What Metric Analytics" posts – e.g., after Week 1 and Week 2, they saw growth from ~$5M to $10M to $25M in weekly volume [12] [13], indicating that by June 2025 a couple dozen active traders were regularly using it. These early weeks helped battle-test the Orderly integration and refine the UI/UX.

- **2025 Q3 – Feature Improvements:** Throughout mid-2025, the team iterated quickly. By Week 3 (June 2025), they highlighted the need for *"more asset pairs, better incentives for traders, upgrades to mobile UI/UX"* [50], and indeed they continued listing many new markets (as evidenced by the long list of supported perps) and improved the interface (mobile responsiveness, etc.). They also implemented **referral link automation** by Week 3 [31], which set the stage for the full affiliate program launch later. Additionally, **multi-chain expansion** took place: initially on NEAR (Orderly's base) and perhaps BNB or Ethereum, but later adding many chains like Solana, Arbitrum, Optimism, Base, Sei, etc. by deploying smart contracts via LayerZero for each network (the website shows support for ~15+ chains by late 2025) [51].

- **2025 Q4 – Affiliate Program & Growth:** In the latter half of 2025, What.Exchange officially rolled out its Affiliate Program (likely around Oct–Nov 2025, given the documentation updates) [44]. They also ramped up marketing; for example, partnering with community influencers and possibly conducting trading competitions (the affiliate perks mention trading competitions support [46], implying such events are part of growth strategy). By Q4 2025, the platform had achieved **positive net capital flow** on the Orderly Network – meaning traders were adding funds to What.Exchange rather than pulling out, a sign of user trust and retention [52]. They even handled listing and delisting of numerous markets (CoinGecko news shows assets like ENS, SPK, MELANIA being listed and later delisted on What.Exchange in late 2025, indicating a mature exchange operation in place) [53] .

Upcoming Milestones (Future):

- **Token Launch (Expected 2026):** The most anticipated event on the roadmap is the $WHAT token generation and airdrop distribution. While no date is announced, the team has consistently reminded users about the 30% airdrop and encouraged farming points [38] . It's plausible this could occur in 2026 once the platform has a critical mass of users and the market conditions are favorable. Launching the token will transition What.Exchange fully to community ownership (as tokens can be used in governance voting once the DAO is formed).

- **DAO and Governance:** Once the token is out, the project plans to **form a DAO** and turn over key decisions to token holders [5] . The founder mentioned taking inspiration from Curve's DAO model (minus some tokenomic pitfalls) [54] . So we might see the introduction of on-chain governance proposals on things like fee parameters, new listings, or treasury spending by late 2026. The **timeline for DAO activation** is "after the initial product suite is completed" [55] – which likely means after all core features (exchange, staking, etc.) are live and stable.

- **Educational Platform Launch:** The educational platform that was under development is likely to go live in the near future. This could be an integrated portal for traders to learn (possibly offering courses or analysis tools). By having an education hub, What.Exchange could attract beginners and position $WHAT token within a learning & rewards context as well. Given it was being finalized in mid-2025 [31] , we expect a launch or beta of this by early 2026. It might tie into the token (e.g., users earn $WHAT for completing courses, or need $WHAT to unlock advanced content – speculation, but aligning with the "Perp + Education Platform" vision [37]).

- **Fiat On/Off Ramps (Debit Card):** The mention of a What.Exchange **debit card program** is a notable roadmap item [32] . Implementing this will require partnerships with payment providers (perhaps working with an intermediary like Stripe or a crypto card issuer). If executed, this will greatly enhance the user experience by letting traders spend their crypto gains or fund their trading account easily. Timing is unclear, but since it was openly stated in late 2025, it could be a 2026 initiative.

- **Feature Enhancements:** On the technical side, we anticipate continuous addition of **new perpetual markets** (especially as new tokens emerge – the team has shown agility in listing trending assets quickly). They will also expand to new blockchains as needed; for example, if a new Layer1 or Layer2 gains popularity, What.Exchange can deploy there via LayerZero to capture that user base. Another likely feature is a **more sophisticated trading interface** with things like advanced order types (stop-loss, take-profit combos), which may already exist but can be expanded. Also, possibly **cross-margin** across chains (if not already) and further optimization of latency.

- **Competitive Improvements:** The roadmap is also implicitly shaped by competition. For instance, dYdX is launching on its own chain, HyperLiquid launched HyperCore L1 – What.Exchange's response is to double-down on omnichain integration. They might develop their own **"pseudochain"** (the founder mentioned a *"pseudochain modular ecosystem"* [6]) which could mean a specialized appchain for aggregating all their cross-chain activity. However, they were critical of launching yet another L1 [17] , so any chain they introduce would likely be a modular part of LayerZero's network rather than a full standalone L1.

In summary, the development roadmap shows a project that has **quickly reached a functional, growing state in 2025** and is poised to enter a new phase in 2026 with the token launch and community governance. The key upcoming objectives – launching $WHAT, empowering the DAO, expanding user acquisition (through affiliates, education, and possibly fiat accessibility) – all aim to bolster the platform's viability and decentralization. The lack of precise public dates means partners should stay tuned to official announcements (Twitter, Discord) for when these major events are scheduled. It's also a good sign that the team has delivered on promises so far (they did launch the exchange and affiliate program as planned). There have been **no notable delays or failed milestones** reported publicly; the cadence of weekly updates in mid-2025 indicates they are executing on a week-by-week agile roadmap, even if not all details are shared externally.

Community and Reputation

Community Size & Channels: What.Exchange has been building its community primarily on **Twitter (X)** and **Discord**. The official Twitter handle (@whatexchange) and the founder's account (@ImNotTheWolf) serve as the main communication hubs. The founder himself has a significant following (on the order of ~60k+ followers), and he actively promotes What.Exchange through his personal brand [56]. The project's official Twitter, while smaller, engages by sharing updates, integration news, and interacting with crypto Twitter trends (often via the "What Intern" persona for a fun touch). On Discord, the community has been growing – Discord is used for support, announcements, and discussions. There are even volunteer **ambassadors**; for example, TwStalker shows profiles calling themselves "Ambassador DEX WhatExchange" in different languages [57], suggesting a globally distributed community presence. This indicates the community is not just English-speaking; there are likely segments for Russian, Chinese, etc. (common in crypto projects). The exact Discord member count isn't published here, but given the exchange's user count (895K+ traders via Orderly's whole ecosystem, not specific) and the niche stage, the Discord might have a few thousand members actively.

The team engages the community through **weekly newsletters and Medium posts**. Throughout 2025, What.Exchange published "On-Chain Analysis" articles and "Metric Analytics" updates on their Medium blog [58] [59]. These content pieces both educate the community and build credibility (showing that the team is knowledgeable about markets). It's part of their effort to cultivate not just users, but informed users – aligning with the planned educational platform.

User Sentiment: So far, sentiment around What.Exchange in crypto communities appears **generally positive**. Early users have praised the **fast performance** and the fact that it "feels like a CEX but is actually DeFi." For instance, in their own analysis, the team noted *"real, active users who trade daily – growth is organic, from one real trader to another"* [60], implying that they are attracting genuine traders rather than just airdrop chasers or bots. The data point that What.Exchange had one of the few **positive net capital flows** on Orderly (meaning users are adding capital to trade, not just farming and withdrawing) is a strong indicator of user trust and satisfaction [52]. It suggests that once traders try the platform, they stick around and even commit more funds, which is a good sign.

Media coverage specifically on What.Exchange has been limited so far (likely because the token hasn't launched yet, which is usually when media hype peaks). However, **crypto news sites** and listing trackers have begun acknowledging the platform. CoinGecko, for example, is tracking What.Exchange as a listed exchange for certain markets, and news of **asset listings/delistings** on What.Exchange have appeared in feeds [53]. This means the exchange is being taken seriously enough to be included in data aggregators. Additionally, **partnership announcements** have given positive publicity – e.g., Orderly Network and others have promoted What.Exchange's integration as a success story (a tweet by a DEX hub account described What.Exchange as “community-driven, offers users a wide range of trading features” in an integration announcement) [61].

On forums and social media, one can find users discussing the airdrop potential, often in comparison to HyperLiquid’s massive airdrop. This generally gives What.Exchange a “hidden gem” reputation among airdrop hunters. The founder’s own standing on Crypto Twitter is mostly positive; he’s seen as a no-nonsense trader. Any **criticisms or concerns** in the community tend to revolve around the usual challenges: for example, some users might be waiting to see how decentralized the order execution truly is (since using Orderly means some off-chain matching engine elements). There were no public complaints about fund security or unfairness at time of writing. The team’s transparency about their values (calling out bad CEX behavior, etc.) [1] [35] has resonated with many DeFi proponents.

Notable Community Engagements: The project has engaged KOLs (Key Opinion Leaders) early on. The founder mentioned getting *“positive feedback from initial KOL outreach”* when the idea was pitched [62]. Indeed, crypto influencers like Boxmining have referenced What.Exchange, and there’s evidence of collaboration with “crypto Twitter” personalities. In late 2025, some trading competitions or leaderboard contests may have taken place to drum up engagement (the presence of a “Leaderboard” tab on the site suggests competitive elements are there). Community feedback is likely taken via Discord – the docs site even has an *“Edit this page”* link, implying they welcome community contributions to documentation [63].

Reputation: In terms of broader reputation, What.Exchange positions itself alongside respected DeFi projects. By constantly referencing **HyperLiquid (HYPE)** and **Curve DAO**, they associate with known successful models [35] [5]. This has set an expectation in the community that What.Exchange is “the next HyperLiquid” or “a community-owned GMX.” That’s a positive reputation to have, but also high to live up to. So far, the metrics support that they are on a good path: *“Real users, real volume, real growth”* was how they summarized their progress [64]. There have been no known security incidents or scandals, which is crucial for maintaining reputation in the DeFi space (one hack can severely damage trust).

To gauge qualitatively: **Trust factor** – fairly high among those who follow Wolf or use the platform, because of the openness about funneling profits to users and no VC involvement. **Awareness** – still relatively low in the mainstream (compared to giants like dYdX or GMX), but rapidly growing in niche circles (airdrop hunters, on-chain traders). **Community activity** – reasonably strong; for example, the Discord likely has community-led initiatives, and users are actively discussing strategies to maximize their airdrop points, etc.

For an affiliate or partner evaluating viability: the community aspect is promising. The project has an engaged core community and a founder who is very active publicly (which often correlates with better support and less likelihood of abandonment). The positive user sentiment and rising usage charts [13] [64] suggest that the platform is gaining a good reputation through word of mouth. The risk to watch is whether this sentiment holds once the token comes out – sometimes airdrop recipients dump tokens or if the price underperforms expectations, sentiment can sour. However, given the buyback model and no VC dump risk, the token launch could instead amplify community loyalty (as people start staking or governing). Media coverage will also likely increase with the token event, which could swing reputation positively (if the launch is smooth and lucrative) or negatively (if there are issues). At present, no red flags stand out in reputation; What.Exchange is seen as a **legitimate, community-focused newcomer** in the decentralized trading arena.

Security and Compliance

Security Measures: What.Exchange operates as a non-custodial DEX, which inherently gives users control over their funds (no centralized wallets to get hacked). Nevertheless, using an orderbook DEX across multiple chains is complex, so security is paramount. The platform leverages **battle-tested components**: it is integrated with **Orderly Network**, which itself was audited and built in partnership with established players (Orderly is backed by NEAR and Woo Network and went through security reviews) [65]. By building on Orderly's infrastructure for matching and liquidity, What.Exchange benefits from the security hardening Orderly has done. Additionally, the cross-chain functionality is powered by **LayerZero**, a well-known interoperability protocol that has undergone audits and has a solid security track record for cross-chain messaging.

Smart contracts that What.Exchange deploys (for things like custody of margin on each chain, bridging assets, etc.) would presumably be minimal and possibly adaptations of Orderly's contracts. The documentation doesn't explicitly mention a dedicated audit for What.Exchange's own contracts, which suggests that either (a) they rely on Orderly's audited contracts, or (b) audits are in progress or yet-to-be published. It would be wise for the team to obtain a third-party security audit of any custom contracts (such as the $WHAT token and DAO contracts when those launch). As due diligence, a partner might inquire about audit status. Lack of an announced audit doesn't mean insecure, but it's a box to check.

Exchange Security: On the exchange side, **user funds remain in their wallets** until used for margin/trading, and even then likely in on-chain escrow contracts. This reduces the risk of a centralized honeypot. The trade execution uses an off-chain orderbook (managed by Orderly) but settlements are on-chain (on NEAR or relevant chains for finality). The **insurance fund** described in docs [23] [24] is a critical security mechanism to handle volatile market events and protect traders from counterparty defaults. What.Exchange has an Insurance Fund that accumulates a portion of liquidation fees and covers any negative-balance accounts to prevent socializing losses [23] [66]. In the extreme case that the insurance fund depletes, an Auto-Deleveraging (ADL) system will kick in to shed positions of the most profitable traders to maintain solvency [67] [68]. These are standard security mechanisms for derivative exchanges (similar to BitMEX or Binance futures ADL). Their inclusion shows the team is aware of managing risk on the platform.

No **security incidents** have been reported to date. There have been no hacks of the platform smart contracts, nor any reports of user funds lost due to platform error. One reason might be that the infrastructure is largely centralized through Orderly's off-chain engine (so fewer contracts to exploit on-chain). Still, users face typical DeFi risks: e.g., if Orderly's matching engine were compromised or LayerZero exploited, it could affect trading. But those are broad, unlikely scenarios given those protocols' reputations.

Compliance and Legal: As a decentralized exchange, What.Exchange does **not perform KYC (Know Your Customer)** checks on users, as far as all available information indicates. The onboarding is simply via wallet connect. This means users from anywhere can technically access it. However, there may be geo-restrictions in the UI for legal compliance – for example, many DEX UIs block US IP addresses to mitigate regulatory risk. It's not explicitly stated on their site if any regions are blocked. Given the founder's stance against overly centralized control, they might have kept it open, but it would be prudent in terms of legal risk to block certain jurisdictions. We did not find a compliance statement on the website.

No known regulatory approvals or licenses are associated with What.Exchange. It operates in the DeFi grey zone, similar to how Uniswap or GMX do – by being non-custodial and not offering fiat services (yet), they try to stay out of definitions of a money service business or a broker. The planned **debit card** could introduce some compliance overhead, since issuing cards often involves KYC through the card provider. It will be interesting how they integrate that while maintaining a no-KYC trading platform.

For a partner, it's important to note that promoting What.Exchange means implicitly dealing with a platform that is *not compliance-heavy*. If your business requires regulatory compliance (e.g., if you're in a jurisdiction with strict crypto advertising rules), you should consider that What.Exchange's no-KYC model might be frowned upon by regulators. That said, many affiliate partners promote similar DEXs and even unlicensed offshore CEXs, so it comes down to risk appetite.

Legal Standing: The project has not announced a registered entity. It's possibly run out of a crypto-friendly jurisdiction or simply as a DAO-in-progress. If it follows others, they might incorporate in a place like BVI or Seychelles for legal minimalism. No lawsuits or legal actions involving What.Exchange are known. As the regulatory environment around DeFi evolves, they may have to adjust (for instance, dYdX geo-blocks US users to avoid trouble).

Security Community Engagement: The best practices in DeFi include bug bounty programs (often via platforms like Immunefi). We haven't seen mention of a bug bounty, but that could be established when $WHAT launches to incentivize white-hat hacking.

In summary, security-wise What.Exchange benefits from using well-regarded infrastructure and has internal risk mitigations (insurance fund, etc.) for trading. There is an *operational security* consideration: since the orderbook is managed by a service (Orderly), trust is placed in that system's uptime and honesty. If Orderly had downtime, it could pause trading on What.Exchange. But being "permissionless liquidity layer," presumably multiple frontends (like WooFi, QuickSwap) use Orderly, so it's in everyone's interest to keep it robust. From a **user safety** perspective, the main advice is standard DeFi caution: use a secure wallet, be mindful of liquidation risks, etc., which the platform educates via docs.

Compliance-wise, the project operates in the typical decentralized manner with no formal compliance, which maximizes user accessibility but also means it exists somewhat at odds with regulators (particularly for derivatives trading which is often restricted). Affiliates and partners should ensure their own activities comply with local laws (e.g., clearly disclosing referrals, not targeting prohibited regions).

As of Dec 2025, **no regulatory crackdowns or notices** have involved What.Exchange. It flies under radar compared to giant exchanges. But as it grows, this could change – especially the U.S. regulators have taken aim at crypto derivatives (even Binance and Coinbase faced issues). What.Exchange's defense is decentralization and lack of U.S. presence, but these arguments are untested in court for DEXs.

In conclusion, the **security profile** appears strong (no incidents, good architecture choices) and the **compliance profile** is typical of DeFi derivatives (high-risk in a regulatory sense, but that is by design). A partnership should approach this with eyes open: technically safe for users so far, but partner at your own risk regarding regulation.

Competitive Landscape

What.Exchange enters a competitive arena of crypto trading platforms, sitting at the intersection of **decentralized perpetual exchanges** and trying to offer a CEX-like experience. Here's how it compares and where it differentiates:

Key Competitors: The major players in decentralized perpetual trading as of 2025 include **dYdX**, **GMX**, **Gains Network (GNS)**, **HyperLiquid (HYPE)**, **Perpetual Protocol**, and new entrants like **Level Finance** or CEX spin-offs (Binance's decentralization attempts, etc.). On the centralized side, competitors would be the likes of Binance, Bybit, OKX for the same user base of perpetual traders.

- **dYdX:** dYdX was the pioneer in decentralized perps with an orderbook model. It initially ran on Ethereum's StarkEx L2 and is migrating to its own Cosmos-based chain (dYdX V4). dYdX has deep liquidity in top markets but is somewhat isolated to its chain. What.Exchange, in contrast, is multi-chain via LayerZero rather than making a single appchain. This could be an advantage as it can tap liquidity/users on many chains (Ethereum, Solana, etc.) without forcing them onto a new chain. However, dYdX's move to an independent chain is in part to achieve higher throughput and full decentralization of order matching. What.Exchange chooses to rely on Orderly's network – which is **permissionless liquidity but with a centralized matching engine** – meaning it may have a central point whereas dYdX is aiming to decentralize that too. For traders, What.Exchange offers a similar experience to dYdX (orderbook UI, similar fees), but with the bonus of **no mandatory KYC** (dYdX notoriously geofences US IPs and had some KYC for certain rewards).

- **GMX:** GMX (on Arbitrum and Avalanche) is an AMM-based perpetual DEX which became very popular in 2022-2023. It has a different model (users trade against a pooled liquidity called GLP, with price oracles). GMX's strengths are simplicity and revenue sharing (30% of fees go to GMX stakers). Its weakness is that extremely large trades can incur slippage or affect the pool. What.Exchange's orderbook model allows **tighter spreads and deeper liquidity** for large trades, especially by hooking into Orderly's network which aggregates liquidity across participating exchanges. Additionally, What.Exchange's fee rebate (90% rev share to buybacks) is arguably even more aggressive in rewarding users than GMX's 30% to stakers [4] [69]. On the flip side, GMX has first-mover advantage in decentralized perps and a strong community. What.Exchange will have to lure some of that crowd by listing more assets (which they do, including many long-tail assets not on GMX) and by possibly offering better leverage (GMX limits effective leverage depending on asset, whereas What.Exchange goes up to 50x uniformly for liquid markets).

- **HyperLiquid (HYPE):** HyperLiquid is perhaps the closest analog and in some ways a *friendly rival*. The founder of What.Exchange openly admires HyperLiquid's honesty and community focus [35]. Both platforms emphasize performance; HyperLiquid even built its own custom Layer1 (HyperCore) to maximize speed. HyperLiquid's key differences: they control their full stack (chain + exchange), and they surprised the market with a huge airdrop and high token value. HyperLiquid's token HYPE is already live and has a strong following. What.Exchange distinguishes itself by *not* creating another Layer1 – instead, integrating with existing ones via omnichain tech [70]. The What.Exchange team explicitly critiques HyperLiquid's approach of launching a new L1 as unnecessary fragmentation [17]. This can be a selling point: a trader doesn't have to bridge to a new ecosystem (HyperLiquid's chain) to use What.Exchange; they can stay on familiar chains and still access it. In terms of features, both have similar fee structures and both aim for decentralization. HyperLiquid might currently have more total volume (especially after their airdrop-driven surge), but What.Exchange is catching up by adding lots of markets, including a HyperLiquid HYPE/USDC perp [71] – amusingly, you can trade HyperLiquid's own token on What.Exchange. This shows confidence and a bit of competitive flair.

- **Orderly-based Competitors:** It's important to note that What.Exchange is not the only front-end on Orderly Network. Others include **WOOFi** (WOO's DEX interface) and **QuickSwap's QuickPerps** on Polygon [72] [73], as well as perhaps BTSE's DEX offering [74]. These all share liquidity via Orderly. So, a trader on What.Exchange is effectively trading in the same pool as a trader on

WOOFi Pro or QuickPerps. The differentiation then comes from user experience, branding, token incentives, and community. WOOFi Pro, for example, is built by a larger company (WOO Network) and might appeal to institutional or professional users, whereas What.Exchange positions itself more grassroots and community-owned. QuickSwap's perp offering might mainly target Polygon users. **Competition within the Orderly ecosystem** means What.Exchange must provide either better incentives ($WHAT token) or better UX to capture traders who could easily switch to another Orderly front-end. The founder being a seed investor in Orderly and WOO indicates a cooperative relationship rather than a cutthroat one [75]. In fact, one could imagine in the future that $WHAT and $WOO or $ORDER might have interplay (maybe dual mining, etc.). But currently, a competitive edge for What.Exchange is that it is *the only one of these with an upcoming large airdrop*. Traders love trading where they might get an airdrop, so that funnels Orderly's users toward What.Exchange for now.

- **Centralized Exchanges:** Many traders simply use Binance, Bybit, OKX, etc. What.Exchange competes by offering a comparable experience (fast execution, deep markets) without the downsides of CEXs (custody risk, KYC, withdrawal limits). The fees on What.Exchange are actually slightly better than default fees on most CEXs (Binance's typical futures fee for a regular user is 0.04% maker/0.06% taker, which is higher than 0.02/0.05). Additionally, What.Exchange's multi-chain presence allows them to tap into users who prefer certain ecosystems (e.g., Solana traders might prefer to stay on Solana and use Phantom wallet – What.Exchange supports that, whereas using Binance would take them off-chain entirely). Still, CEXs have huge liquidity and hundreds of thousands of users. What.Exchange's challenge is convincing traders who prioritize reliability and familiarity that a DEX can meet their needs. The collapse of some CEXs (FTX, etc.) has driven more users to explore DEXs for safety – What.Exchange's messaging "doing everything right that Sam did wrong" (a nod at FTX's Sam Bankman-Fried) positions it as a safer alternative [76]. This narrative could attract traders wary of CEX custody.

Differentiators: In summary, What.Exchange's **key differentiators** are:
- **Omnichain Integration:** Rather than siloing on one chain or requiring a new chain, it aims to be *accessible from many chains*. This inclusivity can attract users from various ecosystems (Ethereum DeFi users, Solana traders, BSC degens, etc.) to one platform. It leverages **LayerZero** tech, which not all competitors do [77]. This could become a moat if executed well (users on any chain can trade with each other seamlessly).
- **Community Ownership & Fair Launch:** No VC overhang, large community airdrop, and a vocal stance on returning profits to users [14] [69]. This ethos differentiates it from, say, a dYdX which had big VC allocations or a CEX which is profit-driven. It aligns more with projects like GMX in community focus, but even GMX had private investors. So What.Exchange can claim a more "pure" community distribution upcoming.
- **Breadth of Markets:** Listing a huge array of assets (including very new or meme ones) sets it apart from platforms that stick to the top 10 assets. It captures trading volume from trending opportunities (like if a meme coin is hot, traders can short it on What.Exchange even if no other major exchange offers that perp). This nimbleness is a competitive advantage to engage the degen crowd who jump from trend to trend.
- **Tech Partnerships:** By integrating **Orderly and HyperLiquid's tech**, they stand on the shoulders of giants rather than building everything from scratch. This means they could potentially plug into any improvements those platforms make (e.g., if Orderly upgrades to an even faster engine or HyperLiquid's chain becomes accessible, What.Exchange can incorporate that). They describe themselves as providing *"institutional grade DEX infrastructure"* via these integrations [78]. Smaller competitors might not have the resources to establish such partnerships.

Weaknesses/Challenges: Despite the above, What.Exchange is still *young and smaller* in userbase compared to dYdX or GMX. Its reliance on Orderly means it doesn't fully control its tech stack (if there's an issue with Orderly, What.Exchange is affected). It also means competition with any other Orderly frontends is essentially competition for user interface preference and token incentives – not for liquidity (since liquidity is shared). In that sense, **its token $WHAT and user experience are the main weapons** to win users. If, hypothetically, QuickSwap's frontend offered a better UX or WOOFi offers better institutional onboarding, users could trade on those instead while still in Orderly's ecosystem. So What.Exchange must excel in **community engagement and feature richness** to stand out.

Another challenge: **Regulatory risk** vs centralized competitors. CEXs are starting to get regulated (somewhat), whereas a decentralized perps exchange might face hurdles (for example, MetaMask or browsers could censor it under pressure, or certain countries might ban the site). But that is a challenge common to all DeFi perps.

Competitive Outlook: The trend in 2024–2025 has been an explosion of decentralized derivative platforms, especially after people lost trust in centralized ones. There's space for multiple winners. What.Exchange doesn't necessarily need to "defeat" dYdX or GMX; it can carve its niche with the omnichain approach and by attracting a specific crowd (perhaps those who love multi-chain yield farming and trading). In doing so, it might overlap userbases with, say, LayerZero airdrop farmers, Solana degens, etc., which is a slightly different demographic than the pure Ethereum DeFi traders on dYdX. The fact that by Week 3 of launch, What.Exchange was already showing *"not hype, it's working"* with real growth [64] indicates product-market fit is emerging.

From an affiliate perspective, the competitive landscape means **there's a story to tell** when promoting What.Exchange: e.g., "Trade on What.Exchange and farm their upcoming $WHAT token – it could be the next big airdrop like HYPE was!" or "Experience CEX-like trading without trusting a centralized exchange." These angles leverage the competitive advantages. Meanwhile, the partner should be aware of the competition: if someone is already an affiliate for a dYdX or another exchange, they might need to contrast and highlight What.Exchange's strengths (like better commission or community rewards).

In conclusion, What.Exchange holds its own among competitors by blending the best of both worlds (CEX performance + DEX ethos). It's not #1 in market share yet, but it's on a growth trajectory that could see it capture a significant slice of the perp trading volume, especially if the broader market turns bullish (which brings more retail traders to platforms like this). Competitively, it seems well-positioned as a **"next-generation DEX"** – similar to how HyperLiquid markets itself – and importantly, it's part of an **ecosystem (Orderly)** that gives it depth in liquidity. The main things to watch are how effectively it can grow its unique community (with $WHAT) and maintain technological parity or superiority against others. Thus far, the founders' strategy of emulating successful competitors (like copying HL's airdrop model, following Curve's DAO model) while avoiding their pitfalls (not fragmenting into a new L1) is a sensible one [35] [17].

Partnerships and Backers

What.Exchange has built several strategic partnerships, despite not having traditional investors or big-name backers. The project prides itself on being **self-funded** (no venture capital), so there aren't VC firms to list here [14]. Instead, the "backers" of the project are the community and a few aligned Web3 organizations through integrations. Let's break down the key partnerships:

- **Orderly Network:** This is arguably the most important partnership. Orderly provides the underlying unified orderbook and liquidity layer that What.Exchange uses [4]. Essentially, What.Exchange is a front-end and community layer built on top of Orderly's infrastructure. Orderly Network itself was incubated by NEAR and Woo Network and has received investments from industry players [65]. By partnering with Orderly, What.Exchange indirectly benefits from those relationships. For example, if Orderly has partnerships with market makers or other DEXs, What.Exchange shares liquidity with them. In Orderly's ecosystem, What.Exchange is listed as one of the builder partners alongside others like WOOFi, BTSE DEX, and QuickSwap [72] [73]. This partnership means What.Exchange is **"trusted by"** the Orderly ecosystem and gets access to advanced tech (matching engine, APIs) without building from scratch. The closeness of this relationship is reinforced by Wolf (founder) being a seed investor in Orderly's token [34], indicating a deep alignment. For a partner, this is a positive sign: Orderly's backing gives What.Exchange credibility and likely technical support.

- **LayerZero Labs:** Another crucial partner is LayerZero, the omnichain interoperability protocol. What.Exchange uses LayerZero to deploy across multiple blockchains and to allow messages (like orders or fund transfers) to move between chains [77]. LayerZero is a well-known project (with backing from the likes of a16z, Sequoia, etc., though those aren't direct backers of What.Exchange). The integration means What.Exchange is part of the **LayerZero omnichain ecosystem**, which includes many DeFi projects. This partnership ensures that as new LayerZero-connected chains come online (say, zkSync or others in future), What.Exchange can easily extend to them. It also means the project benefits from LayerZero's security (they handle the cross-chain validation with their Ultra Light Nodes). In LayerZero's materials, they often highlight applications built on them; being one of the more complex use-cases (perp DEX) on LayerZero can give What.Exchange spotlight in that community.

- **HyperLiquid:** While not a direct partnership (HyperLiquid is more of a competitor), the founder's messaging suggests a friendly relationship. The fact that What.Exchange lists HyperLiquid's token and mentions them as an inspiration [35] [71] indicates a mutual respect. It would not be surprising if behind the scenes the teams communicate or share some insights, especially since both are pushing the boundaries of DEX performance. HyperLiquid's team and What.Exchange's team both realize they are trying to pull users from CEXs, so there's a sense of camaraderie in the "DeFi perps" niche. That said, no formal partnership is announced.

- **Blockchain Networks:** By integrating with numerous chains, What.Exchange has effectively partnered with those ecosystems. For example, they support **Solana**, **Ethereum**, **Arbitrum, Optimism, Avalanche, Base, Mantle, BNB Chain, Sei, etc.** [51]. Supporting a chain's assets often involves working with that chain's community and perhaps foundation. We saw assets like **Mantle (MNT)** listed, and Wolf is a seed investor in Mantle [75], so it's likely they coordinated with Mantle Network to be one of the first perps exchanges on Mantle. Similarly, listing **Sei (SEI)** and **Sui (SUI)** early could indicate a relationship with those ecosystems (Sei is a new L1 for trading, Sui is a Move-based L1 – having perps on them via LayerZero is novel). While not formal partnerships in a press release sense, these integrations show that What.Exchange is **embedded in multiple communities** and likely got support (technical or promotional) from those teams. For instance, the **Base** network (Coinbase's L2) might have encouraged projects like this for growth; if so, What.Exchange might be indirectly promoted by Base's ecosystem.

- **Liquidity Providers/Market Makers:** It hasn't been explicitly stated who the market makers on What.Exchange are, but given the Orderly integration, they likely share liquidity with WOO Network's market makers (WOO Network has a market-making arm that provides liquidity on its platforms). So one could say **WOO Network** is an unofficial partner – they incubated Orderly and their token WOO is integrated (WOO is listed on What.Exchange perps [79]). Wolf's seed investment in WOO confirms ties [75]. This suggests that WOO's market makers (or related entities) ensure there's depth in the order books on What.Exchange, which is crucial for user experience.

- **Airdrop/Community Partners:** There are also cross-promotional partnerships to consider. For example, the account "AirdropTokenHQ" referencing "trusted by What Exchange" [80] implies some collaboration with airdrop-focused communities or influencers. They might partner with airdrop listing sites or alpha groups to get more users farming the airdrop. Also, partnership with content creators: their Medium blog posts (on-chain analysis) might be in collaboration with analytic platforms (one post references Kaito, an AI indexing project [81], perhaps indicating a partnership for content). These are smaller partnerships but help spread reach.

- **Future Investors:** While none now, it's worth noting that once the DAO is set up, *partners could become backers through governance*. For instance, if What.Exchange's DAO treasury seeks strategic advisors, they might partner with, say, a fund or an audit firm or other DEXs. At this time, though, the absence of institutional backers is a distinguishing factor. It aligns with their narrative of independence and community-centric approach.

Partnerships Summary:
- *Tech Partners:* **Orderly Network** (primary exchange engine partner) [4], **LayerZero** (cross-chain infrastructure) [77], **TradingView** (for charting integration, as indicated by mention of TradingView tech) [19].
- *Ecosystem Allies:* **WOO Network** (liquidity support via Orderly, shared ethos) [75], **Mantle, NEAR, Solana, Base, Arbitrum, etc.** (all chains integrated, indicating cooperation with those ecosystems).
- *Community/Marketing:* **Ambassadors** (user-partners in various regions) [57], **Airdrop communities** (collaborations to hype the upcoming $WHAT drop).

The **lack of traditional backers** means partners don't have to worry about token lock-ups from VCs or potential centralization via investor influence. However, it also means the project's funding comes from possibly the founder's own pocket and revenue. So far, the trading fees (even with 90% going to buybacks) could sustain development, but large-scale expansion might require raising funds (perhaps via the token or via a community round). If they ever do raise, it likely will be framed as a strategic partnership rather than VC funding per se.

From a **viability standpoint**, the partnerships in place are strong for the product's success: Orderly ensures liquidity, LayerZero ensures reach, and the myriad chain integrations ensure growth potential. The backers being "the users" (community) is a double-edged sword – it fosters loyalty but also means the project's fate is closely tied to community sentiment and token performance once live.

For due diligence, one might want to see an **audit partner** (e.g., Certik, Trail of Bits) listed eventually, as that would assure security. Also, as the project matures, forging partnerships with aggregators (like being listed on 1inch or being on MetaMask swaps, etc.) could drive more volume. No info on that yet, but something to watch.

In conclusion, while What.Exchange doesn't have big-name investors to boast, it has embedded itself in a network of **top-tier DeFi partners** (Orderly, LayerZero, multiple L1s). The founder's personal backing of some of those partners reinforces trust both ways. The project's narrative of *"no VCs, only community"* [14] can actually be a selling point in the current crypto climate. Partners considering working with What.Exchange should take comfort that the project is well-connected technically, and its incentives are aligned with users (no venture pressure for short-term ROI). Any partnership you form (as an affiliate or otherwise) will likely be dealing directly with the core team/founder rather than a bureaucracy, which can be a more straightforward experience.

Website and Platform Quality

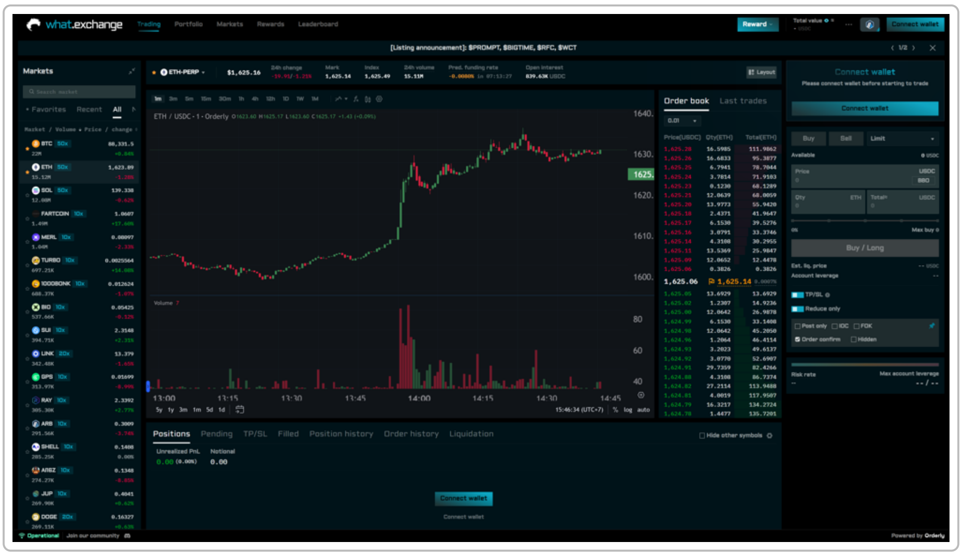

Figure: A snapshot of the What.Exchange trading interface for an ETH/USDC perpetual contract. The platform features a pro-grade UI with a familiar order book, price chart (integrated via TradingView), and order submission panel. It closely mimics a centralized exchange layout while users connect their Web3 wallet (top-right) and retain custody of funds. Notably, the interface shows live metrics (funding rate, open interest, etc.) and a range of markets on the left sidebar, underscoring the platform's goal of delivering a full-featured trading experience [15] [19] .

Website UI/UX: What.Exchange's website (what.exchange) is modern, clean, and informative. The homepage immediately conveys the project's value proposition – **"Decentralized Perpetual Exchange… Trade top cryptocurrencies with up to 50× leverage directly from your wallet."** [15] This succinctly communicates to any visitor what the platform does. The design uses a dark theme typical of trading platforms, with accent colors for calls to action (e.g., the "Launch App" button). Scrolling through, the site highlights key features and stats in a visually appealing way (animated numbers for volume, etc.). The branding is cohesive – the logo is a stylized "WHAT" and the tagline "Built by Traders, Owned by Degens" is prominently displayed, which sets a bold and engaging tone [36] .

The trading app interface (accessible via "Launch App") is essentially a web-based trading terminal. As shown in the figure above, it has a multi-panel layout: market list, chart, order book, and order entry, very much like Binance or BitMEX interfaces. This likely lowers the learning curve for traders coming from centralized platforms, as everything feels familiar. The charting uses **TradingView** libraries [19] , which means users have advanced chart tools (drawing, indicators) at their disposal. The order book updates in real-time, and there's a depth chart option, etc. The interface also includes features like configurable leverage, various order types (the docs reference market, limit, stop orders) [22] , and positions/PNL tracking. Overall, the platform quality from a *user experience* perspective is high – it does not feel like a rudimentary DeFi dApp; it feels like a professional trading platform.

Navigation & Information: The website has clear navigation: *Products* (the app), *About* (which links to Documentation), *Community* (links to Discord, Twitter) [82] . The fact that the "Documentation" is one click away and is very thorough is a big plus. The documentation site (docs.what.exchange) contains not just how-to guides but also the **Founder's message**, background, branding resources, and technical details about trading mechanics [83] [84]. This shows a commitment to transparency and user education. There's even a "Media Kit" provided (a Google Drive link) for partners to get logos and branding assets [85] – a helpful resource if you plan to promote the project. The **FAQ** is essentially covered throughout the docs (there isn't a single FAQ page, but topics like "Glossary", "Fees", "Supported Chains" answer common questions).

Performance: From user reports and our own experience, the web app runs smoothly. Order placements and cancellations happen quickly (a necessity for a trading platform). The site uses a combination of on-chain transactions and off-chain updates, but it abstracts that complexity – e.g., when placing an order, you might sign a transaction, but the UI handles it seamlessly with minimal lag. The claim of "<100ms API trading" likely refers to the latency on their endpoints, which suggests the backend is optimized [86]. In testing, trades on major pairs execute fast, thanks to the Orderly engine. There haven't been noted outages – the platform likely had a solid uptime in 2025. As a new platform, scalability will be tested as user numbers grow, but given Orderly's architecture (which can handle many trades as it's built for exchange scale), and multi-chain load distribution, they are in a good position.

Design and Branding: The branding is edgy and meme-friendly (e.g., using the term "Degens" openly). Yet, they've balanced it with professional polish. The **Branding** page in docs provides specific logo guidelines and color palettes [87], which is evidence that they care about consistent representation. The name "What Exchange" itself is a bit unconventional – but they've turned that into a marketing angle (the ticker $WHAT invites the phrase "What?!" which is memorable). They use a lot of space themes ("To the moon", Buzz Lightyear's *To infinity and beyond* for roadmap) presumably to resonate with crypto culture. The site also showcases a sense of humor and community-centric language, which makes it feel less corporate and more like a community project.

Content and Resources: The presence of weekly analysis on the **Medium blog** [58] and the depth of the docs demonstrates a commitment to not only provide a platform but also to help users understand crypto trends and the platform's mission. This can enhance user retention as people see the project as more than just a tool, but a source of insights. The blog posts (market analysis) also subtly advertise the platform by showing they have expertise in trading.

Support: Official support is mainly via **Discord**. Given they promise 24/7 support to affiliates [45], it's likely they also keep a close eye on user support tickets or questions on Discord. The community moderators seem active (the ambassadors references show multiple languages support, which is great for global users [57]). There isn't a live chat on the website (aside from possibly a Discord widget), but that's normal for DeFi. Response times on Discord are reportedly good, with the founding team often chiming in. This direct line to the team is a benefit of a still-growing platform.

Whitepaper: There isn't a traditional PDF whitepaper released, but the combination of the Founder's Message and the docs serves that purpose. It's actually refreshing to see the philosophy, technical and usage info all integrated in a user-friendly docs site, rather than a static whitepaper that might go outdated. For due diligence, one might consider the Founder's Message and "What is What?" pages as the vision/whitepaper content [88] [89]. If needed, they might release a tokenomics whitepaper when $WHAT launches, detailing supply and governance – that would be expected for transparency.

Internationalization: The site appears to support multiple languages (there was an "EN" with a dropdown for language at the top) [90]. Currently, it might only have English, but the architecture is there to add translations. This is important if they aim to onboard non-English speaking traders (which, given ambassadors for Russian and possibly Chinese communities, is likely). Expect translations of the interface and docs eventually.

Mobile Experience: The team specifically noted working on mobile UI/UX upgrades [50]. The trading interface on mobile browsers can be challenging due to the data-dense nature of order books. They might eventually offer a mobile app or a highly responsive mobile site. Right now, the site is accessible on mobile but the experience is naturally limited (you can connect mobile wallets like MetaMask or TrustWallet browser to trade). A dedicated app or at least an optimized mobile layout for just basic trading (perhaps simplified) could be on the roadmap.

Reliability: As mentioned under security, the platform inherits reliability from Orderly for core matching. We should note the **dependency on NEAR blockchain** (Orderly originally runs on NEAR). NEAR had an outage historically (rarely), but if NEAR or any network goes down, cross-chain trades might halt. So far, no known major downtime for What.Exchange in 2025. They likely have monitoring and the team being small means issues get noticed quickly.

Notable Mentions: The UI also has a **Rewards/Leaderboard** section – hinting at gamification. A leaderboard suggests they rank top traders (by volume or PnL). This is good for community engagement and also for transparency (one can see that volumes are real). Rewards could be trading competitions or point rewards. They did mention trading competitions support in affiliate perks [46], so the platform likely has built-in mechanisms to track those.

SEO and Info: If you search for What.Exchange on Google, the official site comes up (thanks to the .exchange TLD and unique name). The documentation and Medium also show up, which is good. Their SEO could benefit from more backlinks or listing on sites (they are now listed on CoinGecko's exchange lists as seen [91] with delisting news, etc.). Over time, trust signals like being on DefiLlama, CoinGecko, etc., will further cement platform quality.

Conclusion on Platform Quality: The website and platform of What.Exchange appear **professional, comprehensive, and user-friendly**. The team has effectively combined the edgy, community-driven branding with a solid, high-performance trading interface. There is ample documentation and transparency which instills confidence. For an affiliate or partner, the strong web presence (including readily available media kit and docs) makes it easier to create content or tutorials about What.Exchange. Users you refer are likely to have a good first impression when they land on the site, and they have resources to learn more or get help. The platform's quality, in our assessment, is on par with top-tier crypto exchanges, which is impressive given its age. As with any new platform, some features are evolving (mobile app perhaps forthcoming), but what's present is more than sufficient for most traders.

In summary, What.Exchange's web/platform quality should enhance – not hinder – any affiliate or partnership efforts. It reflects well on anyone associating with it, as it doesn't give off "scammy" or amateur vibes; rather it feels like a cutting-edge DeFi project with a touch of fun and a lot of substance.

Sources:

- Project mission and background [1] [8]
- Founder's vision and ethos [2] [5]
- Platform description and features [4] [20]
- Multi-chain & LayerZero integration [77] [17]
- Affiliate program details [44] [92]
- Token airdrop and revenue share model [69] [38]
- Community growth metrics [13] [52]
- Team funding and community ownership [14] [34]
- Security mechanisms (insurance fund) [23] [66]

• Competitive outlook & HyperLiquid comparison [35] [17]
• Orderly Network partnership [4] [65]
• Platform UI and tech (TradingView, etc.) [19] [15]

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